

Ekansh Sharma

CONTACT INFORMATION

Email: ekansharma@google.com
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Google, Mountain View, CA, USA
Machine Learning Engineer *September 2025 - Present*
YouTube Shorts

- Develop recommender systems for YouTube Shorts.
- Develop large language models for Youtube recommendation.
- Study scaling laws for recommender systems.

EDUCATION

University of Toronto, Toronto, ON, Canada
Doctor of Philosophy, Computer Science, conferred November 2025
Thesis: *Exploiting linear connectivity modulo permutations in neural networks for parsimonious machine learning*
Adviser: Prof. Daniel M. Roy

University of Toronto, Toronto, ON, Canada
Master of Science, Computer Science, conferred 2018
Thesis: *Sparse exchangeable bi-partite graphs*
Adviser: Prof. Daniel M. Roy

University of Toronto, Toronto, ON, Canada
Bachelor of Applied Science with Honors, Electrical Engineering, conferred 2016
Minor in Robotics and Mechatronics

PREPRINTS

Liu Q., Yan B., Liu Y., Roh Y., **Sharma E.**, Yin L., Olowo E., Tsai M.-H., Li Y., Uribe D., Aggarwal S., Wu S., Hao Y., Kedigehalli V., Heldt L., Hong L., Wei L., Yi X. "TokenMinds: Pretrained User Tokens and Embeddings for User Understanding in Large Recommender Systems." *arXiv preprint* [arXiv:2606.25147](https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.25147).

Sharma E., Roy D.M., Dziugaite G. K.. "The non-local merging problem: Permutation symmetries and variance collapse." *arXiv preprint* [arXiv:2410.12766](https://arxiv.org/abs/2410.12766).

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

Adnan M., Jain R., Jacobs T., **Sharma E.**, Krishnan R., Burkholz R., Ioannou Y. "SparseOpt: Addressing Normalization-induced Gradient Skew in Sparse Training." *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2026, Seoul, Korea* ([arXiv:2605.27541](https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.27541)).

Mohammed A., Jain R., **Sharma E.**, Krishnan, R, Ioannou, Y. "Sparse Training from Random Initialization: Aligning Lottery Ticket Masks using Weight Symmetry." *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2025, Vancouver, Canada*

Sharma E., Kwok D., Denton T., Roy D.M., Rolnick D., Dziugaite G. K.. "Simultaneous linear connectivity of neural networks modulo permutation." *Joint European Conference on Machine Learning and Knowledge Discovery in Databases. Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland, 2024* ([link](#)).

Naulet Z., Roy D.M., **Sharma E.**, Victor Veitch. "Bootstrap estimators for the tail-index and for the count statistics of graphex processes", *Electronic Journal of Statistics, Electron. J. Statist. 15(1), 282-325, 2021* ([link](#)).

REFEREED
CONFERENCE
ABSTRACTS AND
PRESENTATIONS

Adnan, M., **Sharma, E.**, Krishnan, R, Ioannou, Y. “Understanding Normalization Layers for Sparse Training.” Presented at the *HiLD: 3rd Workshop on High-dimensional Learning Dynamics* co-located with ICML 2025. Vancouver, Canada ([link](#)).

Jain, R., Adnan, M., **Sharma, E.**, Ioannou, Y. “Winning Tickets from Random Initialization: Aligning Masks for Sparse Training.” Presented at the *UniReps: 2nd Edition of the Workshop on Unifying Representations in Neural Models.* co-located with NeurIPS 2024. Vancouver, Canada ([link](#)).

Sharma E., Kwok D., Denton T., Roy D.M., Rolnick D., Dziugaite G. K. “Simultaneous linear connectivity of neural networks modulo permutation.” Presented at the *Conference on Parsimony and Learning*, Spotlight Track 2024. Hong Kong, China ([link](#)).

Singh D., **Sharma E.** , Roy D. M., Dziugaite G.K. “Flat minima can fail to transfer to downstream tasks.” Presented at the *PAC-Bayes meets Interactive Learning Workshop* co-located with ICML 2023. Hawaii, USA ([link](#)).

Sharma E., Roy D. M.. “Approximations in Probabilistic Programs: a Compositional Nonasymptotic analysis of Nested MCMC” Presented at the *ProbProg 2020* Cambridge, Massachusetts, USA ([poster](#), [talk](#)).

Sharma E., Roy D. M.. “Auxiliary variables in probabilistic programs.” Presented at the *Probabilistic Programming Systems Workshop (PPS 2018)* co-located with POPL2018. Los Angeles, California, USA. ([slides](#))

Erdman L, **Sharma E.**,Unternahrer E., Dass S.H., ODonnell K., Mostafavi S., Edgar R., Kobor M., Gaudreau H., Meaney M. and Goldenberg A.. “Modeling trajectories of mental health: challenges and opportunities.” Presented at the *In NeurIPS Workshop Machine Learning for Health 2016*, Barcelona, Spain ([link](#)).

TECHNICAL
REPORTS

Sharma E., Roy D. M.. “Approximations in Probabilistic Programs.” *arXiv preprint [arXiv:1912.06791](#)*. ([poster](#))

Veitch, V., **Sharma, E.**, Naulet, Z., Roy, D. M. (2017). “Exchangeable modelling of relational data: checking sparsity, train-test splitting, and sparse exchangeable Poisson matrix factorization.” *arXiv preprint [arXiv:1712.02311](#)*. ([slides](#))

RESEARCH
ASSISTANTSHIPS
AND INTERNSHIPS

Vector Institute, Toronto, ON, Canada

Graduate Research Student

March 2018 - August 2025

Adviser: Prof. Daniel M. Roy

Research Topic: Deep learning; Transfer learning; Model compression.

Interests: My research exploits the geometric properties of deep neural network loss landscapes to design algorithms for model compression and model merging.

Amazon.com, Edinburgh, UK

Applied Scientist Intern

January 2021 to May 2021

Sponsored Display (Ads team)

- Developed counterfactual analysis tools to assess the impact of different ad selection policies aimed at reducing costs for running explicit A/B tests.
- Conducted A/B tests to compare the performance of Upper Confidence Bound (UCB) algorithms against existing baseline ad selection methods at Amazon,

measuring click-conversion rate.

The Hospital for Sick Children, Toronto, ON, Canada

Research Assistant

May 2015 to August 2016

Adviser: Prof. Anna Goldenber

- Implemented a graphical model that combines multiple sources of genetic and genomic data to identify sets of genes that could explain the presence of a disease in a larger number of patients.
- Changed the structure of graphical model that resulted in 40% run-time savings.

Altera Corp., Toronto, ON, Canada

Software Engineering Intern

September 2014 to May 2015

Detailed Placement Team

- Modeled bidirectional long wire congestion on the chip to get better wire use estimate during placement.

Microsoft Corp., Redmond, WA, USA

Software Development Engineering Intern

May 2014 to August 2014

Azure Redis Cache Team

- Developed Redis output-cache provider feature for ASP.NET developers.

UNDERGRADUATE
RESEARCH
PROJECTS

Autonomous Wing Assembly Process

Multidisciplinary Capstone Project

- Client: **Bombardier Aerospace**, North York, ON
- Adviser: Prof. Jonathan Kelly
- Designed and built a functioning prototype of an autonomous robot to join two wing halves for Global Express 7000/8000 series of business jets.

Extending the user-space implementation of online filesystem consistency checker using Linux KVM

- Adviser: Prof. Ashvin Goel
- Worked on RECON, an online filesystem consistency checker.
- Extended the user-space implementation of RECON to use Linux KVM.

AWARDS AND
HONORS

Vector Research Grant

2018-2025

Department of Computer Science 50th Anniversary Graduate Scholarship

2017

University of Toronto Excellence Award

2013, 2015

Dean's Honors List

2011-2016

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, C,C++,C#, Java

Deep-learning frameworks: JAX, PyTorch, Tensorflow

TEACHING
ASSISTANTSHIP

Machine Learning (CSC2515)

Fall 2019, Fall 2021, Fall 2022

Data Structures and Analysis (CSC263)

Fall 2018

Enriched Theory of Computation (CSC240)

Winter 2018

Theory of Computation (CSC236)

Winter 2019, Winter 2017, Fall 2016

RELEVANT
COURSEWORK

Statistical Learning Theory; Graphs, Matrices, and Optimization; Algorithms for Private Data Analysis; Monte Carlo Methods; Computability and Logic; Compilers and Interpreters; Computational Neuroscience; Machine Learning; Inference Algorithms; Random Processes; Neural Networks; Robot Modeling and Control.

ACADEMIC
SERVICES

Served as a reviewer for ICLR 2020, ICLR 2021, NeurIPS2021, ICLR 2022 NeurIPS 2022, ICLR 2023, ICML 2023, NeurIPS 2023, ICML2024, ICML 2025, NeurIPS 2025, NeurIPS 2026.